

House Hige

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"DIE WITH HONOR OR DO NOT DIE AT ALL"

Quick Facts

Status: Baron/Baroness

Origin: Aicruae (Western)

House Name Meaning: Highborn; A person of Noble Status

Founded: 7,460 BR

Founder: Mocar Hige

Seat: Melert (orig. Dira), Western Aicruae

Faction: Divine Faction

Spirit Animal: White Bear

Colors: Blue, Yellow and Green

Wealth: 15,000 Rern

Peak Wealth: 18,000 Rern

Military: Minimal

Religion: Leneyez (Circle of Eternal Light)

Theme Song: Billie Eilish "No Time To Die"

Status by Era

Pre - Empire: Baron

Solis's Era: Diminished. House Hige no longer exists as an independent noble house. In the decades following the civil war, Solis rewarded their loyalty with lands and coin, but without military strength or political connections beyond the crown's favor, the house couldn't sustain itself. The last head of House Hige married his only surviving daughter to House Arvento, folding the Hige bloodline into the ducal house. The Hige Distribution Company was absorbed into Arvento's trade network. The white bear banner no longer flies over Melert.

Crandona's Era: TBD

Minara's Era: A historical footnote. The Hige bloodline continues through House Arvento, and some Arvento members still claim descent from House Hige, meaning having "some" relation to Lady Emillea, mother of Emperor Solis himself.

Key Connections

Allies: None (Pre-Solis)

Royal Tie: House Patton (Via Emillea)

Rivals: House Vika

Why They Matter

House Hige is the underdog story of Aicruae's nobility, a family that clawed its way out of peasantry and never stopped fighting for the respect it was rarely given. Their founder stole money from a dead man to buy a title during a time when being noble could get you killed. For generations, every other house treated them as a joke.

Then Lady Emillea Hige became the mother of the most powerful man in history. Her public murder by Princess Iris didn't just destroy a family; it lit the match that set the entire world on fire. The Hige white bear on Solis's banners was a promise: the wronged and the low-born could rip everything apart.

Nicknames People Call Them During This Era

"The Flour Dusters" (their business is moving food, they smell like grain wagons)"

"The Western Barons"

"The Firstborn of Dira" (Their original seat before famine forced relocation. Old blood, even if nobody cares.)

Heraldry

Crest: Quarterly counterchanged vert and azure (quartered green and blue, with opposite corners matching). A silver bear rampant at center, tongue showing red. One golden wheat sheaf in each quarter. A golden braided rope runs along the top edge of the shield.

Symbolism: Green represents prosperity, growth, and the fertile lands of House Hige's territory

Blue stands for loyalty, steadfastness, and justice. The silver bear rampant symbolizes strength, protection, and ferocity in defense of what is theirs, a bear does not seek conflict but will not back down from it. The four wheat sheaves represent abundance, the agricultural wealth of their holdings, and their role as providers to the realm. The golden rope signifies unity and the ties that hold the house together

Motto: "Die with honor, or do not die at all"

Pre-Empire Era: Baron of Western Aicruae

Status: Baron/Baroness

Faction: Divine Faction (believes in monarchy and the nobility class system)

Seat: Originally the Town of Dira, relocated to the Town of Melert (Western Aicruae) due to famine. One of only two noble houses to ever change location.

Religion: Leneyez (sub-religion of the Circle of Eternal Light)

The Underdog Factor: House Hige held the lowest rank, the least wealth, and zero allies among Aicruae's nobility. No other house took them seriously. They'd tried to branch out diplomatically, only to be rejected every time. Their internal structure was "very wonky" because they could barely keep themselves afloat, let alone manage house affairs properly, leaving family members divided and desperate.

Despite all of this, the house persisted. Their distribution company kept them financially alive, and when Lady Emillea caught the eye of King Benjamin II, it changed the trajectory of the entire world.

Founding Story

Founded: 7,460 BR (three years after the Siege of Highwater)

Founder: Mocar Hige

Origin: Mocar was an ambitious peasant who stole money from his master, a young noble who died during a hunting expedition gone wrong. He used that money to buy a noble title during one of the worst times to be a noble in the country, when nobody wanted to be nobility, and the title itself came with the risk of death.

Mokar and his wife Henra didn't announce their new status immediately. They continued living as peasants, waiting for the chaos of the Siege of Highwater to completely die out before officially revealing their nobility.

The White Bear Origin: the white bear on the Hige crest comes directly from Mokar's past. The young noble master he served used Mokar as bait to hunt a white bear. The master failed and was killed by the animal. Mokar was forced to outsmart and kill the bear himself. When founding the House, he chose this symbol so everyone would know House Hige was just as noble as everyone else, giving the House a pure but ferocious identity.

Power & Influence

Wealth: 15,000 Rern (the least of any noble house). Peak of 18,000 Rern was reached under Benam's management. Their wealth status sits just above a wealthy merchant group.

Military Strength: The littlest among all noble houses. Too new and underfunded to maintain a proper military or guard. They field local levies and retainers rather than grand armies.

Internal Structure: Best described as "very wonky", they barely had enough resources to stay afloat, let alone manage themselves. This left family members divided and willing to do anything to survive.

Key Business Asset: The Hige Distribution Company, founded by Adriane and Benam Hige, this company moved food from one corner of the kingdom to another. It was the family's primary income source and their one genuine achievement. Saperin II's marriage was strategically used to advance the manufacturing of carts that carried Hige goods.

Alliances: None during the Pre-Empire period. No other noble house took House Hige seriously, and every attempt to build diplomatic relationships was rejected. Their only significant connection came through Emillea's relationship with King Benjamin II.

House Culture

Notable Members

These are all the notable members of House Hige.

Founding Generation

Henra Hige (7,510 BR - 7,460 BR)

"The Mother of House Hige." Protected the family during the Siege by becoming a maid to a wealthy feudal noble, then betrayed that noble at the right time. Died around the house's official founding. Mother of Adrione, Benam, Saperin I, and Biba. The name Henra means Muse.

Mokar Hige (7,489 BR - 7,452 BR)

Founder. Stole money from his dead master and bought a noble title during the aftermath of the Siege of Highwater. Killed the white bear that became the house symbol. The Name Mokar Means to Shine.

Second Generation (Children of Mokar & Henra)

Adrione Hige (7,468 BR - 7,422 BR)

The brains behind the Hige Distribution Company, she conceived the idea of moving food across the kingdom. Incapable of having children. The Name Adrione means Carrier/Bringer of Victory.

Benam Hige (7,465 BR - 7,410 BR)

Twin to Biba, first heir. Managed the distribution company to its peak wealth (18,000 Rern). Incapable of having children. Along with Adrione, forced Saperin I into producing heirs for the family. The Name Benam means God's Fury.

Biba Hige (7,465 BR - 7,436 BR)

Twin to Benam. Drowned herself after learning of Saperin I's death because she was very close to her and distraught over losing her. Blamed Benam, Adrione, and herself for what happened to her sister because she couldn't save her sister from

the will of Benam and Adrione. Incapable of having children. The name Biba means Small Bear.

Saperin Hige I (7,461 BR - 7,436 BR)

The only child capable of having children. Forced at age 16 to bed a friend of her brother to produce heirs. Gave birth to four surviving children (two died), died at age 25 during her sixth childbirth. Her children: Tolence, Kason, Saperin II, Breleys. The name Saperin means Sapphire.

The Saperin I Tragedy

Three of four siblings were incapable of having children. The entire future of House Hige fell on the youngest, Saperin I, who was used as a broodmare by her own brother and sister. She was dead by 25. Biba, the sibling who loved her most but couldn't protect her, walked into the water and never came out.

Third Generation (Children of Saperin I)

Tolence Hige (7,440 BR - 7,357 BR)

Very like his uncle Benam, equally incompetent, equally ambitious. Quoted: "There is no such thing as a god, only men." Treated the women in his life as objects to trade for social advancement. Only took advice from men, including his brother Kason. The name Tolence means Tolerant.

Kason Hige "The Fool" (7,438 BR - 7,349 BR)

Earned his epithet by convincing Tolence to invest with Pasilerad Kacer, a con man Kason believed could perform miracles. They gave Pasilerad the family funds and their youngest sister Breleys's hand in marriage believing him to be a local investor. The scheme was only uncovered after Pasilerad's death, they thought they were accumulating money overnight, but it turns out Pasilerad was scamming people using House Hige as a cover. The name Kason means Innocence.

Saperin Hige II (7,437 BR - 7,353 BR)

Like her mother, used as a political tool by her brothers. Married a distant cousin at 18; the marriage advanced cart manufacturing for the distribution company. Unlike her mother, she lived a happy life with a loving husband and children. The name Saperin means Sapphire.

Breleys Hige (7,436 BR - ~7,354 BR)

Married to Pasilerad Kacer at age 12 (he was 30). Spent her entire married life being abused while her family ignored it. Pasilerad left her partially blind. Couldn't give him children. Escaped at 18, took half his money, and seemingly disappeared from the face of the earth. The name Breleys means Paper.

Potely Hige (7,414 BR - 7,382 BR)

Daughter of Tolence. Became a lady-in-waiting to Dowager Lady Ailua of House Aedria hoping to build relations. Tried to seduce the youngest son while serving as his tutor. Failed, was fired by House Aedria, and disowned by her own family to save face. Further cemented House Hige's reputation as a joke. The name Potely means a woman from a high river village.

In Story Characters: A Tale of A Thousand Songs

Lady Emillea Hige (7,270 BR - 7,241 BR)

Concubine/consort of King Benjamin II. Mother of Emperor Solis. Appointed regent for Solis after the king named him heir at the Festival of Mourning. When the king died four months later and the twins staged their coup, Emillea was captured first. While Solis hid under a floorboard, Princess Iris forced Emillea to drink poison in front of a jeering crowd. This became the defining trauma of Solis's life and the catalyst for the civil war. The Name Emillea means Eager Heart.

Key Events Timeline

~7,463 BR — The Siege of Highwater. Henra protects the family by working as a maid and betraying her employer at the right moment.

7,460 BR — House Hige officially founded by Mokar, three years after the Siege. Henra dies around this time.

~7,455 BR — Adrione and Benam found the Hige Distribution Company, moving food across the kingdom.

7,445 BR — Saperin I forced at age 16 to produce heirs for the family, as her three siblings are all incapable of having children.

7,436 BR — Saperin I dies in childbirth at age 25 (sixth pregnancy). Biba drowns herself in grief.

~7,424 BR — Breleys Hige married to Pasilerad Kacer at age 12 by her brothers. Years of abuse follow.

~7,419 BR — Saperin II's marriage advances cart manufacturing for the distribution company.

~7,418 BR — Breleys escapes at 18, takes half of Pasilerad's money, and vanishes.

~7,395 BR — Potely Hige tries to seduce the youngest son of House Aedria. Fired and disowned. House Hige's reputation plummets further.

~7,260 BR — Lady Emillea Hige becomes concubine/consort of King Benjamin II, elevating House Hige's court visibility.

7,250 BR — Solis is born.

7,241 BR — Solis named heir at the Festival of Mourning when he's nine. Emillea appointed regent. King Benjamin dies. The twins coup. Emillea is publicly forced to drink poison by Princess Iris while Solis hides under a floorboard. House Hige members largely eradicated.

Heraldry & Identity

Crest:

Colors and Their Meanings:

Spirit Animal: White Bear; representing strength and the ability to survive harsh conditions.

Motto: "Die With Honor or Do Not Die at All"

House Name Meaning: Highborn: a person of noble status (an aspirational choice for a family that started as peasants).

Reputation & Perception

Public Image: "A little fish in an ocean of sharks and whales." Since their founding, House Hige has been treated as lapdogs by every noble house and never given real respect or authority. Other houses see them as opportunists who don't understand their "place" in high society.

The Pattern: Every generation of Hige tries to climb, and most get knocked back down. Potely tried to seduce her way into House Aedria and got fired. Kason trusted a con man and lost the family fortune. Tolence treated women as currency and got nowhere. Only Emillea's connection to the king broke the cycle, and it cost her life.

The Irony: The family named itself "Highborn" while being the lowest-ranked, poorest, most disrespected house in the kingdom. Their motto demands dying with honor in a family where members have been scammed, abused, disowned, and drowned themselves. The gap between aspiration and reality is House Hige, until Emillea and Solis make good on the name.

Cross-References

House Patton, House Vika, House Aedria, Emperor Solis, Princess Iris, King Benjamin II, Festival of Mourning, Siege of Highwater, Leneyez (Religion), Divine Faction, Town of Melert, Hige Distribution Company

Keywords

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